

Your First 30 Minutes with Obsidian

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First 10 minutes — install and open

1. Install Obsidian using the Mac or Windows handout.
2. Create a vault named Genealogy Research.
3. Create folders named People, Places, Sources, and Research Questions.

Next 10 minutes — make four notes

4. Create one ancestor note.
5. Create one spouse note.
6. Create one place note.
7. Create one source note.

Connect them by typing links such as `[[Matea Silva Díaz]]`, `[[Rincón, Puerto Rico]]`, and `[[1910 U.S. Census — Muñoz household]]`.

Final 10 minutes — bring in AI

8. Take one genealogy record or transcription.
9. Paste only appropriate information into your preferred AI chatbot.
10. Ask for facts, uncertainties, contradictions, and research questions.
11. Ask the AI to return a reviewed Markdown note.
12. Save or download it as a .md file directly into the vault.
13. Return to Obsidian and open the new note.

You now have the beginning of your genealogy research knowledge base.